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API and Service Guide

Welcome to the API and Service Guide. This guide covers everything you need to build, deploy, and operate services that expose HTTP APIs.

Introduction

This guide is for engineers who want to build reliable, well-documented APIs. It assumes you are comfortable with at least one programming language and have a basic understanding of how the web works.

> **Note:** This guide focuses on HTTP/1.1 and HTTP/2 APIs. Other protocols such as gRPC and WebSockets are mentioned briefly but are not covered in depth.

What you will learn

- How to design resource-oriented APIs
- How to implement authentication and authorization
- How to write tests at the unit, integration, and end-to-end levels
- How to deploy and monitor your service in production

Prerequisites

You should be familiar with:

- The command line
- Git
- A programming language of your choice
- Basic networking concepts (TCP, DNS, TLS)

Getting started

Installation

Install the CLI using your package manager:

```
# macOS
brew install example-cli

# Linux
curl -fsSL https://example.com/install.sh | sh

# Windows
winget install example.cli
```

Verify the installation:

```
example --version
```

Hello world

Create a new project and start the development server:

```
example new hello-world
cd hello-world
example dev
```

Open `http://localhost:8080` in your browser. You should see a welcome page.

Language guide

Basic syntax

Variables are declared with `let`. Constants are declared with `const`.

```
let name = "world"
const greeting = "hello"
print(greeting + ", " + name)
```

Data types

Type	Description	Example
`int`	64-bit signed integer	`42`
`float`	64-bit IEEE 754	`3.14`
`bool`	Boolean	`true`
`string`	UTF-8 text	`"hi"`
`list<T>`	Ordered collection	`[1, 2, 3]`
`map<K, V>`	Key-value pairs	`{"a": 1}`

Functions

Functions are declared with `fn`. The last expression is returned implicitly.

```
fn add(a: int, b: int) -> int {
  a + b
}

print(add(2, 3))
```

Control flow

```
if x > 0 {
  print("positive")
} else if x < 0 {
  print("negative")
} else {
  print("zero")
}

for i in 0..10 {
  print(i)
}

while running {
  step()
}
```

Error handling

Errors are values. Functions that can fail return a `result` type.

```
fn parse(s: string) -> result<int, error> {
  // ...
}

match parse("42") {
  ok(n) => print(n),
  err(e) => print("failed: " + e.message),
}
```

Concurrency

Async/await

Mark a function `async` to let it suspend. Call it with `await`.

```
async fn fetch(url: string) -> result<string, error> {
  let resp = await http.get(url)?
  return ok(resp.body)
}
```

Channels

Channels let tasks communicate without sharing memory.

```
let ch = channel<int>(capacity: 8)

spawn {
  for i in 0..100 {
    ch.send(i)
  }
  ch.close()
}

for value in ch {
  print(value)
}
```

Threads

Use threads for CPU-bound work that should not block the event loop.

```
let handle = thread.spawn(fn() -> int {
  heavy_computation()
})

let result = handle.join()
```

Standard library

Collections

The `list` type supports `push`, `pop`, `map`, `filter`, and `reduce`.

```
let xs = [1, 2, 3, 4]
let doubled = xs.map(fn(x) { x * 2 })
let evens = xs.filter(fn(x) { x % 2 == 0 })
let sum = xs.reduce(0, fn(a, b) { a + b })
```

I/O

Read a file:

```
let text = fs.read_to_string("data.txt")?
```

Write a file:

```
fs.write("out.txt", "hello\n")?
```

Networking

Make an HTTP request:

```
let resp = http.get("https://example.com")?
print(resp.status)
print(resp.body)
```

Testing

Tests live next to the code they test. Run them with `example test`.

```
fn test_add() {
  assert_eq(add(2, 3), 5)
}
```

Tooling

Package manager

Add a dependency:

```
example add http-client
```

Formatter

Format all files in the project:

```
example fmt
```

Linter

Run the linter:

```
example lint
```

Debugger

Start the debugger:

```
example debug ./main
```

Advanced topics

Memory model

Memory is managed automatically. There is no garbage collector; values are freed when their owner goes out of scope.

Unsafe code

Unsafe code is allowed inside `unsafe` blocks. Use it sparingly.

```
unsafe {
  let p = ptr.null<int>()
}
```

Foreign function interface

Call C functions with `extern`.

```
extern fn strlen(s: ptr<u8>) -> int
```

Compiler internals

The compiler is written in Rust. It has a lexer, parser, type checker, and code generator.

Appendix

Glossary

Actor
: A unit of concurrency that owns its state and communicates via messages.

Borrow
: A temporary reference to a value owned by someone else.

Channel
: A queue for sending values between tasks.

Changelog

- 1.0.0 — Initial release
- 1.1.0 — Added channels
- 1.2.0 — Added async/await